12 RESPONSIBLE CONSUMPTION AND PRODUCTION

13 CLIMATE ACTION

Being a Responsible Traveller

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A Think about the effects of tourism. Make a list of the positive and negative effects it can have on a place and its inhabitants.

B Work in pairs. What does 'being a responsible tourist' mean? Give examples of responsible behaviour when travelling. Think about these things:

- accommodation
- food
- local communities
- means of transport
- activities
- shopping
- other ideas

C Work in pairs and answer the question. Compare your ideas with other students.

Why do you think we need responsible tourism?

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A Think of two things you know about sustainable and responsible tourism and two things you would like to know.

B Read the article. Look at your answers to Ex 2A. Does the article answer your questions?

C Read the article again. Are the statements true (T), false (F) or not given (NG)?

1 Responsible and sustainable tourism share the same approach. .....

2 Transport is the main cause of greenhouse gas emissions from tourism. .....

3 Travellers are now more aware of how tourism is affecting the environment. .....

4 Sustainable tourism refers to the sustainability of tourism for the whole community now and in the future. .....

5 Responsible tourism refers to actions that someone takes to reduce the impact of their tourism. .....

When it comes to tourism, a responsible choice is adopting a sustainable approach

Responsible and sustainable tourism are not the same thing. They both intend to minimise the negative social, economic and environmental impacts that tourism may have. But they aim to achieve this in different ways.

Sustainable tourism is described by the UN Environment Programme and the UN World Tourism Organization as tourism that considers the economic, social and environmental impacts both now and in the future. As well as the needs of visitors and the industry, it considers the environment and host communities. The term does **not** refer to a specific kind of tourism, but involves different groups of people. It involves political action and decisions at different levels. Its main objective is to reduce the bad impact and to maximise the good impact of tourism, while conserving resources or using them wisely. A very common form of sustainable tourism is 'ecotourism', a term which is now used to describe any form of holiday in relatively undisturbed natural areas. You visit these areas to admire the place and to learn more about their habitats.

Responsible tourism is about improving places for people to live in and places for people to visit. The term refers to the behaviour of individuals. Responsible travellers usually take decisions based on what is best for the environment and the place they visit in the long term. They make sure that the actions based on those decisions have positive economic, social and cultural impacts on local communities, too.



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3 **Look at The United Nations' list of tips for responsible tourists. Choose the three most important tips for you and three tips which you think are the most difficult to follow. Then work in pairs and compare your choices.**

Tips for responsible tourists

- Avoid single-use plastic.
- Don't waste water.
- Buy local.
- Use public transport.
- Stay with a local family or resident.
- Learn as much as possible about your destination before travelling.
- Respect local customs and traditions.
- Eat local food.
- Pack light.
- Reduce your waste.
- Buy handmade souvenirs.

Me	
most important	most difficult

My classmate	
most important	most difficult

Language for citizenship

4 **Complete the text with the words/phrases in the box.**

a huge impact	culturally sensitive
local communities	natural resources
make connections	
negative social, environmental and economic impact	

The tourism industry can make [1] _____ on people, cultures and the planet in general. That is why responsible tourism is becoming so important. The main goals of responsible tourism are to:

- minimise the [2] _____.
- promote the well-being of [3] _____.
- contribute to the conservation of [4] _____.
- [5] _____ with local people to better understand local cultural, social and environmental issues.
- be [6] _____.

CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

5 **Look for the word 'tourism' in the text of the Italian Constitution. How many occurrences does it have?**

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

6 **Do some research on the internet for 'sustainable destinations' around the world. Prepare a two-minute presentation on a sustainable destination you would like to visit.**



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